01
What is Advocacy?

Definition

Advocacy is the act or process of supporting a cause or proposal

https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/advocacy

Disability advocacy is acting, speaking or writing to promote, protect and defend the human rights of people with disability.

https://www.dss.gov.au/sites/default/files/documents/12_2018/disability-advocacy-fact-sheet.pdf

Self Advocacy

At its heart: the ability to communicate what your needs are

Three Key Elements:

Understanding your needs

Knowing what kind of support could help

Communicating your needs to others

What are some examples?

Say you're a student who struggles with writing. But Philosophy 101 requires taking a lot of notes.

If you're a strong self-advocate:

- You understand that taking notes is going to be a challenge for you.
- You know that support like pre-printed notes may help.
- You communicate your challenge to the teacher, and ask for pre-printed notes.
- If the instructor says no, you can determine where to turn next, i.e. the SAS office.

How can I learn to advocate for myself?

The first step is to become more aware of your strengths and challenges.

- Ask yourself: What am I good at? Where do I struggle? What do I like and not like?

You'll also need to learn about different tools, resources, and support — which types might help, and how to ask for them.

As with any valuable skill, it will take time and practice.

02 Importance of Advocacy

It's Important!

Three good reasons why it is important to advocate for yourself and others:

- Raise Awareness
- Shows That You Are Not Alone
- Makes Change

Are there any others you can think of? Share aloud!

03

Advocacy in College and Beyond

Self Advocacy in College

OPEN DISCUSSION

How to advocate for yourself/talk to professors?

When to do it?

Resources you can go to?

What about after college?

Career advice and gaining workplace accommodations?